

Popular



Chess



NUMBER

ONE



Rabbits Review has served the chess amateur faithfully for four years; its successor, Popular Chess, will retain the best features of the old magazine, but add extra dimensions.

Retained: the analysis of games by and of ordinary club players.

Retained: instructional articles for the amateur.

Retained: the numerous diagrams which make the magazine so easy-to-follow, even without a chess set.

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Good luck to the new magazine!

The Notation Battle

The war between the two notations algebraic and descriptive continues. Algebraic has made considerable strides since the introduction of computers, but descriptive has been used in countless old books and it is impracticable to change all of them to algebraic. So it is best to know both, and both are quite simple to learn and apply. Popular Chess hopes its readers will become bi-notational and will print articles in both descriptive and algebraic.

Rabbits Review

Subscribers will find their subscriptions transferred to the new magazine, Popular Chess. The price of the magazine is the same - 90p; and annual sub for six issues is also the same - a five pound note.

Editor is International Master, inventor of the Macho Grob Opening, Mike Basman.

Subscriptions to Popular Chess and back issues of Rabbits Review (Nos.1-12 70p each, Nos. 13-21 £1.00 each post free) available from:

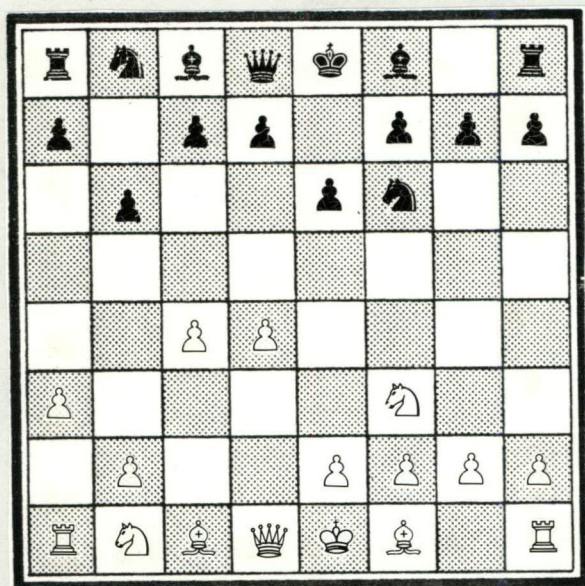
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THE GM GAME

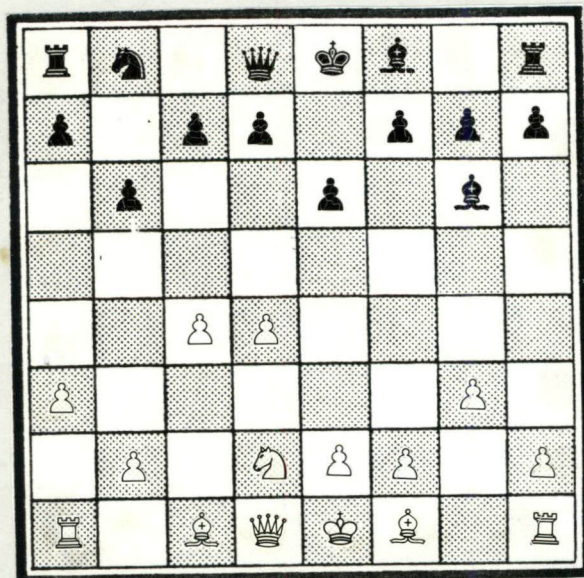
KASPAROV / Andersson

1 d4 Nf6
2 c4 e6
3 Nf3 b6
4 a3



Anderson allows Kasparov to play his favourite opening system in which many famous grandmasters have bitten the dust.

4 ... Bb7
5 Nc3 Ne4
6 Nxe4 Bxe4
7 Nd2 Bg6 !?
8 g3!

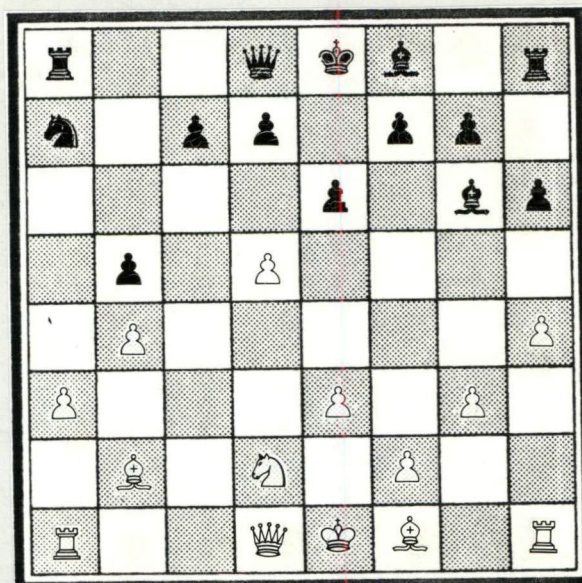


White takes advantage of the fact that the black bishop has made the unusual retreat to 'g6' to seize the long diagonal. 8 e4 was bad because black can put unbearable pressure on the white centre with 8 ... Nc6

8... Nc6
9 e3! a6
10 b4 b5
11 cb5 ab5
12 Bb2

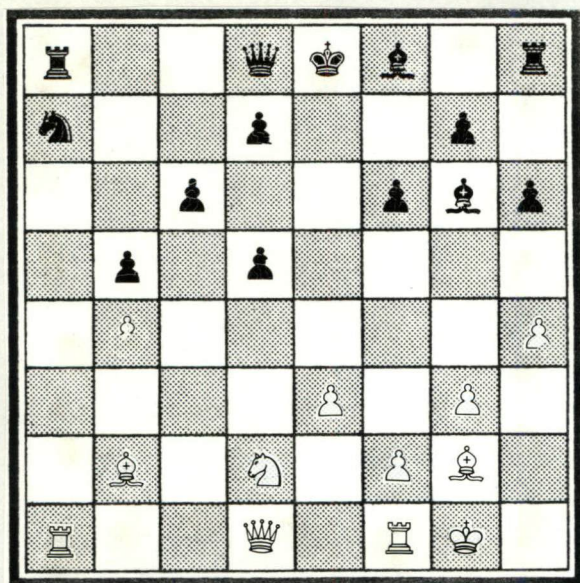
Not 12 Bb5 Nb4! with advantage to black

12... Na7
13 h4 h6
14 d5!



A remarkable move which shows that one must not slavishly adhere to the rules of simple development, but seek ways to hamper one's opponent as well. In this position a natural plan for white would have been to play Bg2, castle and then advance the central pawns. However, black could then also castle himself. With his pawn sacrifice Kasparov sees a way to prevent black from castling on the king side, since now any move of the bishop from f8 will lose the g pawn. As a result the black king will remain in the centre and white's task will then be to open the central files by pawn exchanges, in order to stage a winning attack. Interestingly enough, of white's first 14 moves, nine have been with pawns. The game leaves a strange impression.

14 ... exd5
15 Bg2 c6
16 O-O f6



Black decides to block the bishops diagonal so he can play ... Be7 and ... O-O. Hence the next few moves are cust and thrust affairs with the white trying to open the position before black escapes to safety.

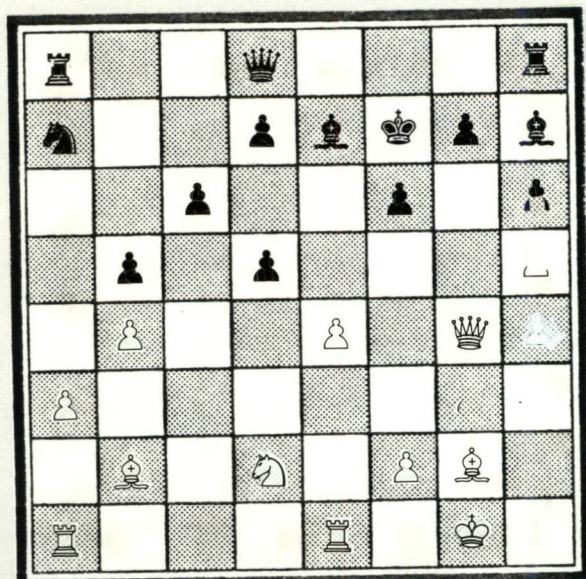
17 Re1 !

White prepares to open the 'e' file.

17 ... Be7
Qg4! Kf7

Now castling is out, but the black king still has a formidable barrier of pawns around his king.

19 h5 Bh7
20 e4!

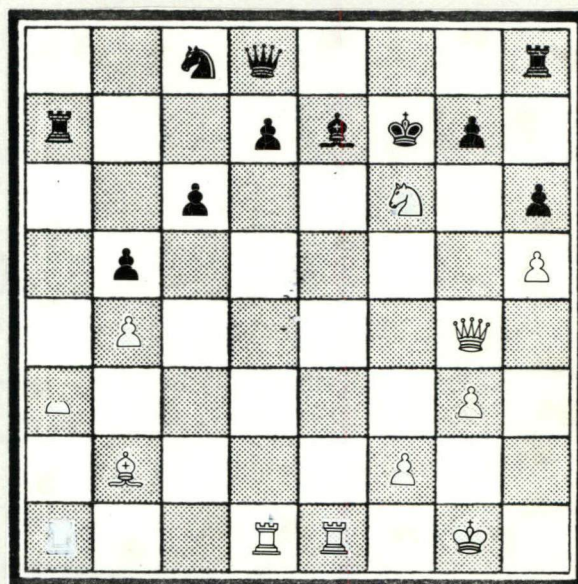


After some strong preparatory moves white at last plays e4. The opening of the 'e' file will be decisive.

20 ... dxe4
21 Bxe4 Bxe4
22 Nxe4

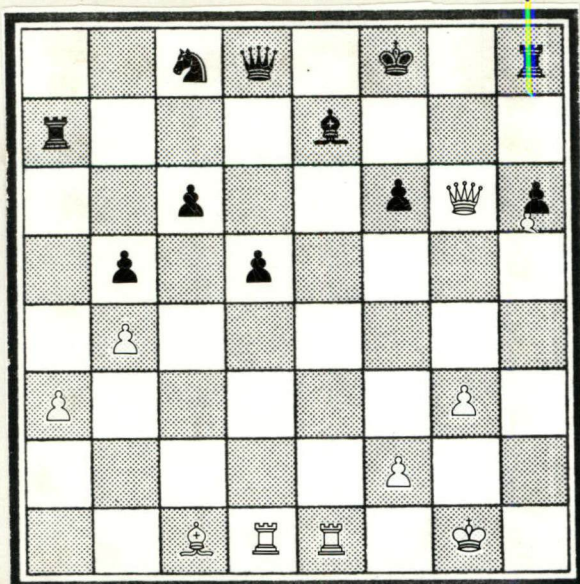
After these bishops are exchanged a gaping hole appears on 'g6'.

22 ... Nc8
23 Rad1 Ra7
24 Nf6!!



A tremendous blow knocks a hole in black king's defences. White has mobilised in the classic manner after all: Rooks centralised, king safe, queen, bishop and knight on dominating active squares. As for black ... well we won't say too much about black's development, except that it wouldn't have been so bad were it not for the fatally weak king. Now if black captures by 24...Bxf6 white winds up brilliantly with 25 Qg6+ Kf8 26 Bxf6 gxf6 27 Re6!! (play this out on your sets) and he must gain the black queen shortly.

24 ... gxf6
25 Qg6+ Kf8
26 Bcl ! d5

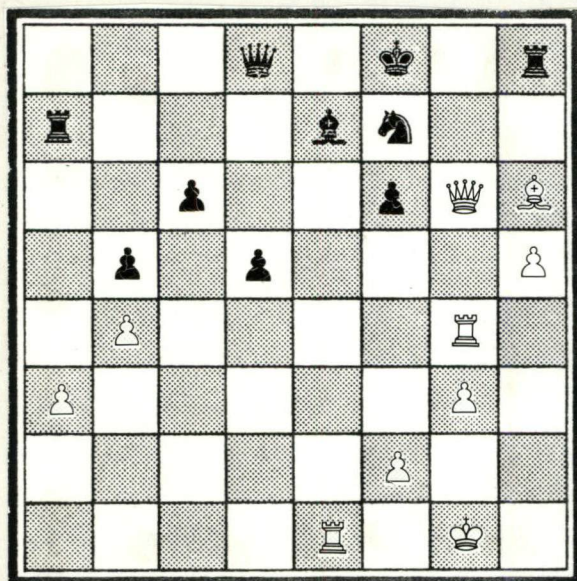


It looks like black has survived the worst, but Kasparov calmly switches another rook to the king side, to create new mating threats.

27 Rd4! Nd6
28 Rg4

Kasparov plays the most accurate moves up until the very end.

28 ... Nf7
29 Bh6+ !



A final brilliant stroke destroys the defensive facade. If the bishop is captured by 29... Rxh6, then 30 Qg8 is mate, whereas 29... Nxe6 sees the demise of black's rook and knight for starters, after 30 Qg7+

29 ...
30 Bg7

Ke8
Resigns

The 'h' pawn goes all the way after 30 ...Rg8.

This game was a fine example of Kasparov's sharp attacking style, all the more remarkable because he makes the world No. 5 player look like a doddering tyro.

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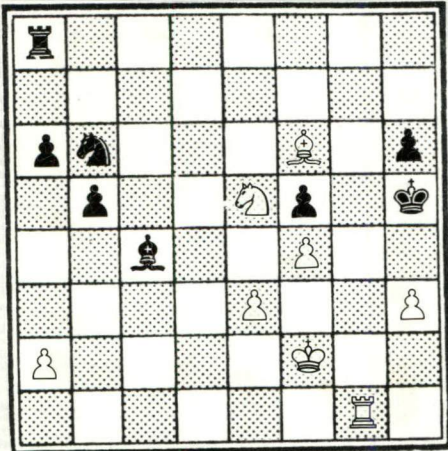
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Le Competition

A record number of entries for last issue's mate in 2 - and all of them were correct!



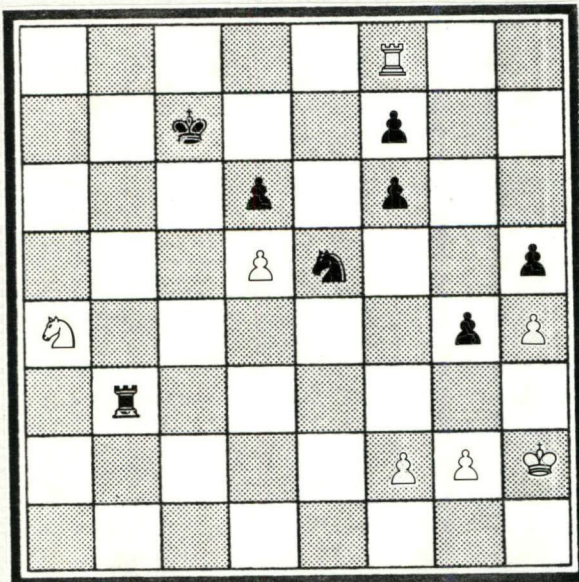
The solution was 1 Rg4 followed by 2 Rh4 mate; if 1 ...fxg4 2 hxg4 is also mate.

The winning name in the prize draw of correct solutions was

N. McBride

who walksoff with the hairy Velcro Set.

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the sacrifice

In the sitting room of his suburban 'semi' Stafford studied the position on his chess board. An intriguing postal game this. By sacrificing a pawn he could open the game right up and gain a strong attack. However, if he advanced his king's pawn he would block the position completely and have a certain draw. Even as he pondered the intricacies of the attack he knew he would settle for the draw.

The clock on the mantel-piece struck seven. He verified the time by glancing at his watch, then rose and pausing only to collect his bowler hat and briefcase from the hall cupboard, walked out to his car.

Twenty minutes later he parked in a dimly lit side street, locked the car and walked briskly through the night. He had memorised his instructions so there was no hesitancy in his step. Anyone seeing him would think him just another faceless businessman returning from a long day at the office. The night was dark and still: ideal for his purpose. After glancing around to make sure he was not observed he slipped through the gap in the fence and clambered up the grassy slope. His employer was right; from the top he had an unobstructed view of the footbridge over the railway line. He opened his briefcase and took out the components. He had assembled them so many times before that now he could do it by instinct. The barrel into the stock, the silencer onto the barrel, the telescopic night-sight into position and the bullet into the breech. Then; the sound of footsteps echoing from the wooden planking and his target was in the crosshairs of the sight. A gentle squeeze on the trigger and the familiar figure was brushed off the bridge to become an inert heap on the railway lines below. Stafford was back home just as his clock was striking eight.

He was writing his move, pawn to king five, when the door bell rang. As soon as he went into the hall he could see through the glass the distinctive helmet and silver buttons of a police uniform. He slowly opened the door.

'Hello Ted'.

'Evening Stafford. I've called to see if you can play for the First Team next Tuesday. Alan Johnson is ill. Will you stand in for him?'

'Yes, I'd be delighted.'

'That's good'. A pause then 'You know old man, I hope you don't mind me saying this, but if you were a bit more aggressive you could be a regular on the First Team. The trouble is that you completely lack the killer instinct.'

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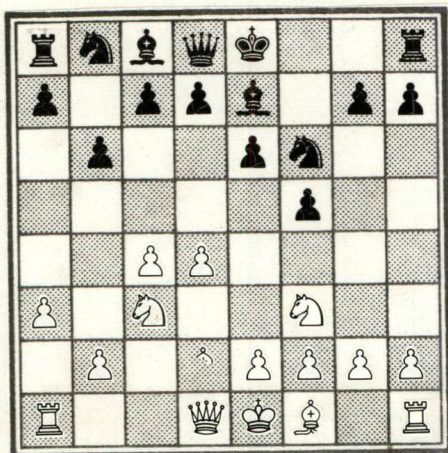
MORGAN'S mutterings

The Analysis of the Month by our Super Rabbit - John Morgan

White: James Buckle (Courier C) Black: Ian Healey (MytholmroydA)

Opening: Dutch Defence Board 1 March 8 1983

1 P-Q4	P-K3
2 P-QB4	P-KB4
3 N-KB3	N-KB3
4 N-QB3	B-N5
5 B-Q2	P-QN3
6 P-QR3	B-K2?

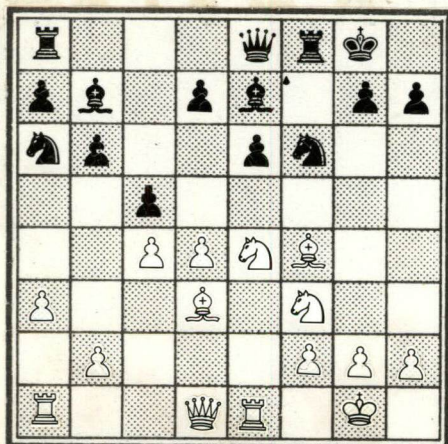


Black's 6th move is a waste of tempo. The idea of black's fourth move is to exchange the queen's knight thereby weakening white's control of the K4 square... a very important square in this defence.

7 P-K3	B-N2
8 B-Q3	O-O
9 O-O	Q-K1
10 R-K1	P-B4

An unusual move for this opening but perfectly reasonable I think. A possible continuation is - 11 PxP BxP 12 P-QN4 B-K2 13 P-K4 with a slight advantage to white.

11 P-K4	PxKP
12 NxP	N-R3
13 B-B4?	

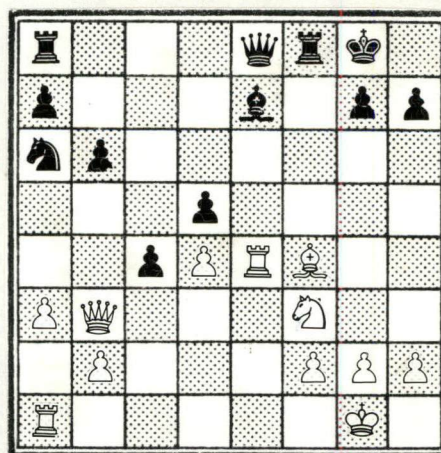


Black now takes advantage of the fact that this bishop is unprotected.

13 ...	NxN
14 BxN	BxB
15 RxB	P-Q4!
16 PxQP	KPxP

Now white cannot move his rook without losing the bishop at KB4. He resorts to tactics.

17 Q-N3! P-B5!



Three white pieces now in danger; white parts with the exchange.

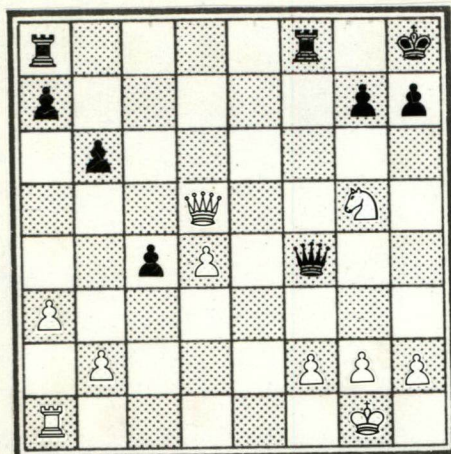
18 RxB! QxR

Ian thought that 18...PxQ was better but after 19 RxQ RxR 20 B-Q2 followed by B-B3 the win does not look easy.

19 Q-N5 N-B2

Here 19...RxB looked better, but white would then reply 20 QxQPch, forking king and rook.

20 BxN	QxB
21 QxP+	K-R1
22 N-N5	Q-B5!

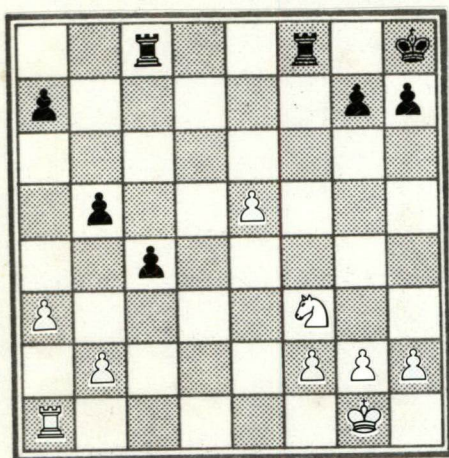


As they say... the best form of defence is attack. In positions such as this 'rabbits' often overlook these active moves presumably on the basis that if one side is attacking the other side has to defend.

23 N-B3 QR-B1
24 Q-K5?

A common mistake. The exchange only helps black. Another frequent 'rabbit' error is to exchange material in a losing position.

24 ... QxQ
25 PxQ P-QN4



White has here one pawn for the exchange, a slight material deficit. However, black has good queen side pawns, and his rooks have a good run on the open files. A tough ending is in prospect, with the balance in black's favour.

26 R-QB1 QR-Q1
27 N-N5?

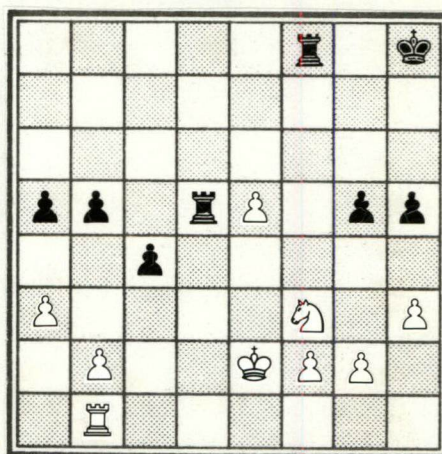
Now this move is very bad, as white is moving a piece twice before he has mobilised his king (opening principles apply in the ending too!) Better was 27 K-B1 followed by K-K2, and if black goes for the QNP with R-Q6 and R-N6, black can guard it for the time being with R-B2.

27... R-Q7!

28 R-N1 P-KR3?
29 N-B3 R-Q4

Black's rook is driven off the seventh, but black keeps his pieces well centralised nonetheless.

30 K-B1 P-QR4
31 K-K2 P-N4
32 P-R3 P-R4!?

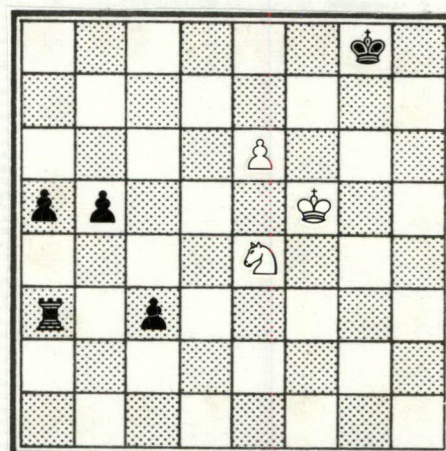
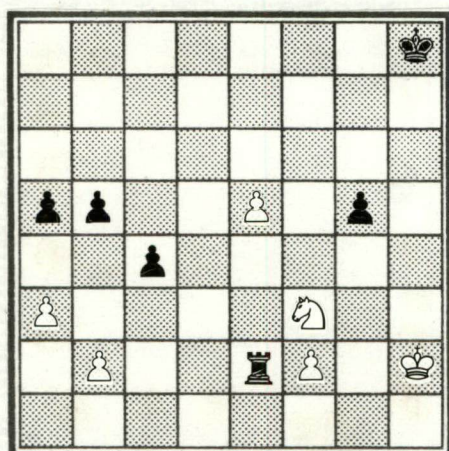


Positionally speaking black should also activate his last piece, by bringing his king over to K3, to blockade the white pawn. But he sees the chance to make quicker dividends with this pawn advance, which threatens to drive away the knight from the defence of the advanced king pawn. Of course 33 NxNP would here lose to the fork 33...RxKP ch.

33 P-KN4 PxP
34 PxP R-B5
35 R-N1 R-K5+
36 K-B1 R-Q8+
37 K-N2 RxP+
38 K-R2 R8xR

When ahead in material, your attack should be stronger, and any exchange of pieces favours you. Heads you win, tails he loses. Black has won a pawn with attack, and he has crippled black's game by exchanging off another pair of rooks. Now white's pieces are all on the wrong side of the board to stop the advancing queen side pawn.

39 NxR R-K5
40 N-B3 R-K7



Ian has played the technical phase of the game very well and is now ready to 'home in' on the weak queenside pawns. The players have reached the 40th move and Ian could stop playing and win on adjudication, but he realises that the task is easy. However, my general advice is if you get to 40 moves and have a winning position - STOP!

There is no point in risking a won game just to show off your brilliant end game technique...it may not always be as good as you think!

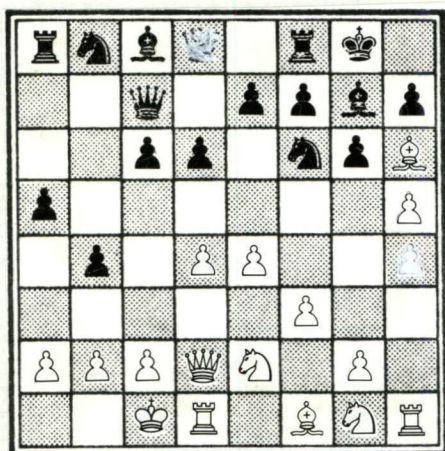
41 N x P	R x P +
42 K - N3	R x P
43 N - K4	R - N6 +
44 K - B4	R x P
45 P - K6	K - N1
46 K - B5	P - B6

(Amazingly enough, black almost blows it here, which just shows the pertinence of Morgan's last comment! Had white played 47 K-B6! What do you think would have been the outcome of the game? Should black have played some other move instead of 46...P-B6? A £2 gift voucher for the best analysis of this position - Ed.)

47 N x P	R x N
48 K - B6	K - B1
49 Resigns	

0 - 1 Well done Ian.

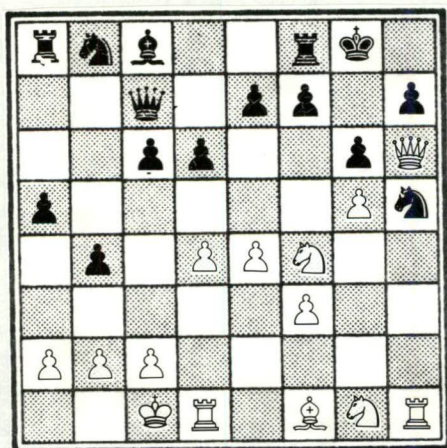
♖ fortress on fire



Ian Josephs in R.R.21 thought that white's attack in the diagram was not conclusive. Many readers sent in strong analyses to show it was. One of the best letters came from 13 year old Julian Way of Esher, and here it is:-

"Mr. Josephs is wrong in saying that Mr. Keene's or Levy's statement is exaggerated. The following continuation wins convincingly for white.

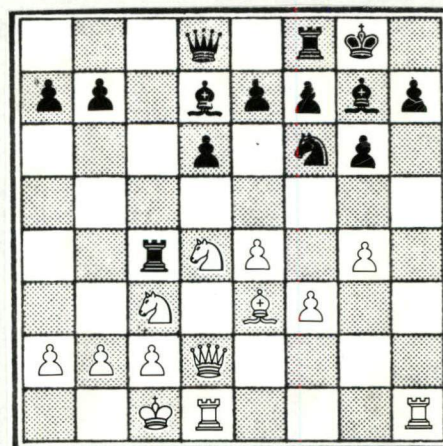
From the diagram, after 11... Bxh6 12 Qxh6 Nxh5 white should continue 13 g4. Black's move 13...Nf6 is forced, to protect mate on h7. White continues 14 g5. Black must play 14...Nh5. Now comes white's block-buster - 15 Nf4! The knight is immune from attack because of the mate at h7; meanwhile white threatens mate in 3 moves beginning with Nxh5. Black's only way to defend h7 is to clear the pawns away from e7 and f7 to allow a lateral guard by the black queen.



If black plays here 14...e5 then 15 Nxh5 gxh5 16 Rxh5 f6 17 B.f4+! is decisive; on the other hand 14...e6 15 Nxh5 gxh5 16 Rxh5 f6 17 exf6, though it defends h7, still leaves black with a fatally exposed king. White threatens Rg5+ and Rg7 for starters."

Well done Julian! There are other ways to fry the fish, but this was very clean cut.

These attacks along the rook file against a fianchettoed bishop at g7 can be very dangerous. Witness how Karpov crushes Korchnoi in 1975 with a very similar attack. (Different opening - Sicilian Dragon - but same king side formation.)



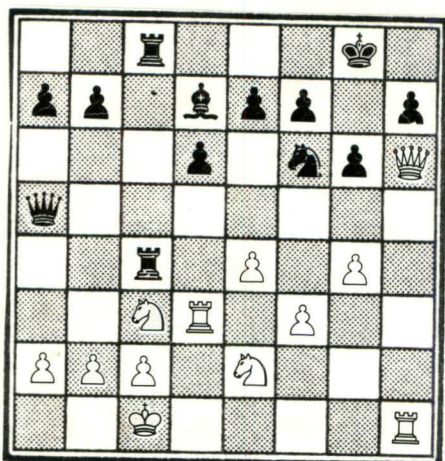
16 Nd4-e2!

This knight is headed somewhere, as we shall see later in the game.

16 ...	Qd8-a5
17 Be3-h6	Bg7xh6
18 Qd2xh6	Rf8-c8

Black is building up heavily on the c file and threatens to break up the white king position with 19...Rc4xc3! So Karpov gives the square extra protection.

19 Rd1-d3!



White's threat here is the same as in the Ian Josephs's position - to play g4-g5 and after ...Nf6-h5, to follow up with Ne2-f4. So Korchnoi gives the g5 square another defender only to find his goose is cooked by a sparkling Karpov dénouement.

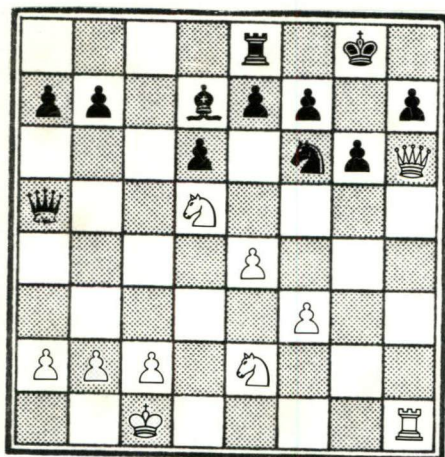
19... Rc4-c5
20 g4-g5

What is happening?

20... Rc5-g5
21 Rd3-d5!!

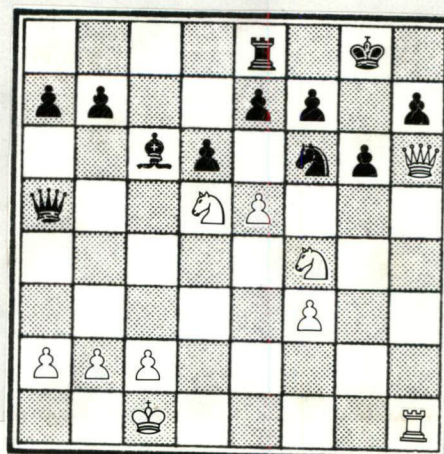
Superb! The knight cannot leave f6 because of mate in 2 starting qxh7+, so black must allow another decoy piece onto d5.

21... Rg5xd5
22 Nc3xd5 Rc8-e8!



Korchnoi grimly defends e7, and is prepared to meet 23 Nd5xf6+ with exf6, followed by escape with his king via e7. But even this does not save him.

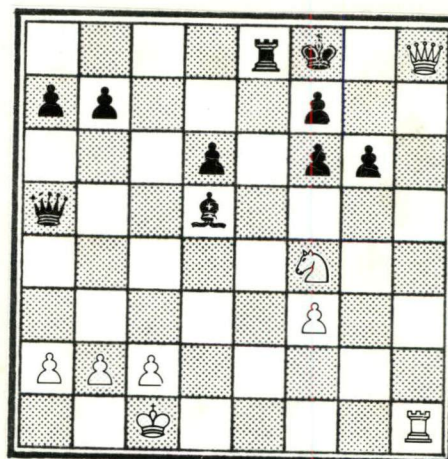
23 Ne2-f4! Bd7-c6
24 e4-e5!!



Another fine interference move. Karpov sees a combination starting 24 Nd5xf6+ exf6 25 Nf4-h5 but also realises that this would be threatened by 25...Qa5-g5+, exchanging the queens.

The move 24 e4-e5! is a deep interference idea preventing the black queen from rushing to the defence of the king side.

24... Bc6xd5
25 exf6 exf6
26 Qh6xh7+ kg8-f8
27 Qh7-h8+ Resigns



White wins quickly after 27 ...Kf8-e7 by 28 Nf4xd5+ Qxd5 29 Rh1-e1+ Ke7-d7 30 Qh8xe8+.

A sparkling game by Karpov, and one of the reasons Mest'el prefers to play ...h7-h5 in the Dragon variations (see Newshound article) to slow up the white attack.

NOVICE

Section

People who have just learnt the moves are served badly by current chess literature. They are expected in no time to be able to understand master games and use tactical weaponry such as pins, forks and sacrifices.

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The game, Noteboom/Doesburgh, Holland 1931, is annotated in Chernev's Logical Chess (available from Audio Chess's book list). But do the test before you read the annotations!

The game began: 1 P-Q4 P-Q4 2 P-QB4 P-K3 3 N-QB3 N-KB3 4 B-N5 QN-Q2

NOW GUESS THE WHITE MOVES

<u>WHITE</u>	<u>BLACK</u>	<u>YOUR MOVE</u>	<u>SCORE</u>
5 P-K3	P-B3	-----	-----
6 P-QR3	B-K2	-----	-----
7 Q-B2	O-O	-----	-----
8 N-B3	P-QR3	-----	-----
9 R-Q1	R-K1	-----	-----
10 B-Q3	PxP	-----	-----
11 BxBP	P-N4	-----	-----
12 B-Q3	P-R3	-----	-----
13 BxN	NxB	-----	-----
14 O-O	B-N2	-----	-----
15 N-K4	NxN	-----	-----
16 BxN	P-KB4	-----	-----
17 B-Q3	Q-N3	-----	-----
18 R-B1	QR-B1	-----	-----
19 P-QN4	Q-Q1	-----	-----
20 N-K5	P-QR4	-----	-----
21 Q-N3	B-Q3	-----	-----
22 BxBP	Q-B3	-----	-----
23 B-N1	BxN	-----	-----
24 PxB	QxKP	-----	-----
25 R-B5	P-R5	-----	-----
26 Q-R2	Q-Q3	-----	-----
27 Q-B2	R(B♯)-Q♯	-----	-----
28 Q-R7 ch	K-B1	-----	-----
29 B-N6	Resigns	-----	-----
		TOTAL	-----

NEWSHOUND reports

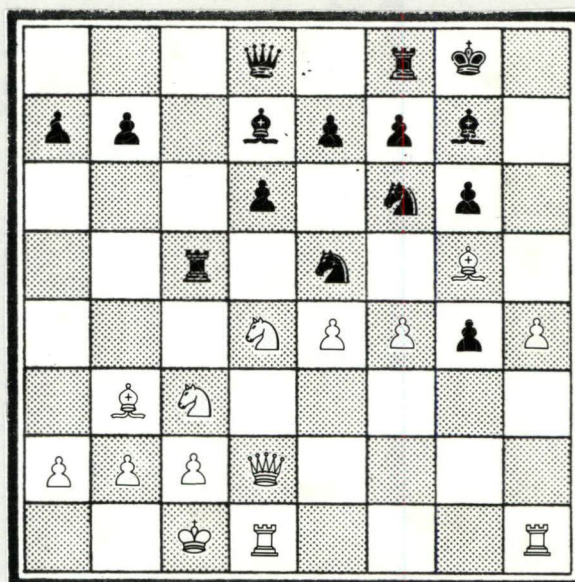
For several years Jonathon Mestel has been bidding to become a grand-master, yet time after time has missed making his final norm by the narrowest of margins. No-one was more surprised than Mestel himself when he was finally awarded the title.

A slight change in F.I.D.E. regulations at their annual congress, held in Lucerne last November, made his score in the 1979 Esbjerg International into a grand-master norm.

At his best Mestel is an absolutely brilliant tactician, full of imaginative sacrificial ideas. A large part of his success can be traced to his fearsome handling of the Sicilian Dragon, the following marvelous game being exemplary.

H. Westerinen - J. Mestel, Esbjerg 1979

- | | |
|----------|-------|
| 1 P-K4 | P-QB4 |
| 2 N-KB3 | P-Q3 |
| 3 P-Q4 | N-KB3 |
| 4 N-B3 | PxP |
| 5 NxP | P-KN3 |
| 6 B-K3 | B-N2 |
| 7 P-B3 | O-O |
| 8 Q-Q2 | N-B3 |
| 9 B-QB4 | B-Q2 |
| 10 P-KR4 | R-B1 |
| 11 B-N3 | P-KR4 |
| 12 O-O-O | N-K4 |
| 13 B-N5 | R-B4 |
| 14 P-N4 | PxP |
| 15 P-B4 | |



Not being an expert of this immensely difficult and highly analysed variation, I feel loath to comment on the moves of either side. I will, however, mention that in Dortmund, several months earlier, Georgadze had beaten Miles with the move 15 BxN. Presumably Mestel had done some homework on this game and Westerinen wasn't curious to see his improvement.

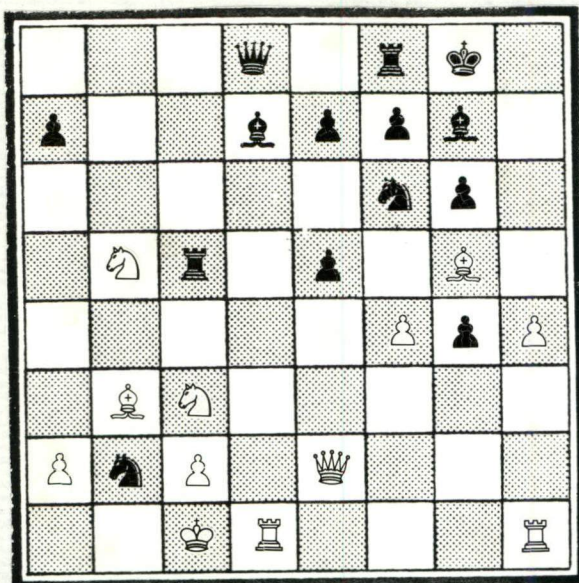
In later games with 14 P-N4 white followed up with the razor-sharp, though far from convincing advance, 15 P-R5.

The next few moves see quite mind-boggling complications, though despite this there are certain underlying strategic themes. White intends to use his centralised pieces to support a kingside blitz, while black will try to unleash his fearsome "dragon bishop", at present hiding on his KN2.

15... N-B5 16 Q-K2 P-N4 17 P-K5?!

White makes his charge but black is solidly entrenched. In view of what now happens I feel tempted to recommend 17 P-B5.

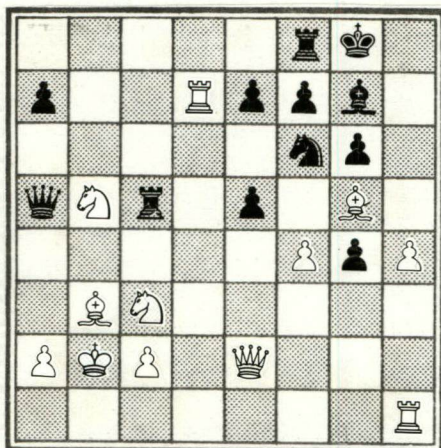
17... PxP 18 N/4xP NxP!!



Brilliant! White is denied the time to recapture on his K5, 19 PxP being met by 19 ... NxR.

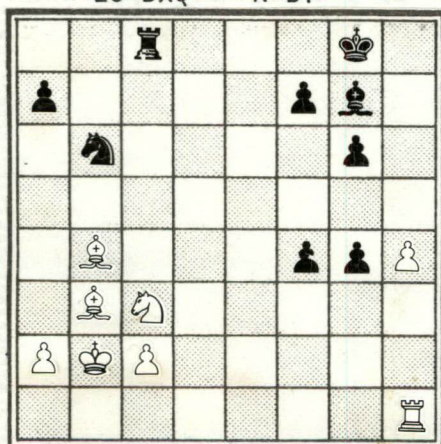
As a result, the black fire-breathing monster breaks free.

19 KxN Q-R4
20 RxB



The variation. 20 BxN BxN 21 NxB BxB 22 QxNP PxPch 23 K-B1 RxN 24 QxPch B-N2 25 QR-N1 (25 KR-N1 Q-R6ch 26 K-Q2 R-Q4ch) Q-B6 is also very good for black.

20... NxR
21 BxKP RxN/6
22 NxR PxP
23 Q-B4 N-N3
24 Q-N4 QxQ
25 BxQ R-B1



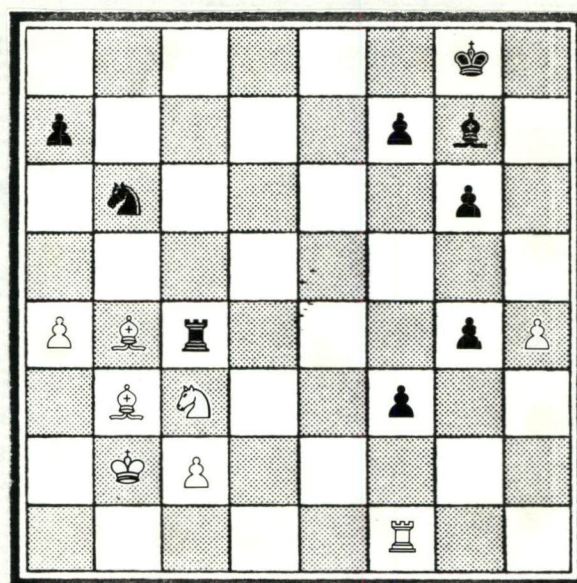
To a large extent the air has cleared. Black has sacrificed a piece for which his compensation is the fierce activity of his pieces and a powerful duo of passed pawns.

With some delightful chess pyrotechnics Mestel underlines the strengths of his position.

26 R-KB1

After 26 P-R4 P-N6 27 R-KN1 B-Q5 28 R-N2, the move 28 ... B-K4!, threatening 29 ... P-B6, is deadly.

26 ... P-B6
27 P-R4 R-B5!!



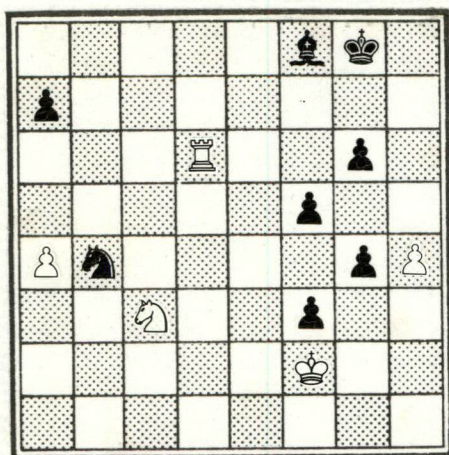
Inspired play! Rather than the mundane 27 ... B-K4 intending 28 ... P-N6 Mestel produces a beautiful idea which wins material.

As 28 B-R5 is met by 28 ... NxPch. White has little choice.

28 BxR NxPch
29 K-B1

Both 29 K-R1 and 29 K-R2 are met by 29 ... P-R4 while both 29 K-N1 and 29 K-N3 are met by 29 ... N-Q7 ch.

29 ... B-R3ch
30 K-Q1 N-K6ch
31 K-K1 NxPch
32 K-B2 NxP
33 R-Q1 P-B4
34 R-Q6 B-B1 !



With three stampeding pawns for the exchange, the issue cannot be in doubt. After 35 RxPch K-B2 36 R-N5 K-B3 and 37... B-B4ch, an advance of the black pawns will win.

35 R-Q8	K-B2
36 K-N3	B-B4
37 N-Q1	K-K3
38 R-Q2	N-Q4
39 P-QR5	N-B3
40 R-QB2	N-R4ch
41 K-R2	P-N6ch

White resigned.

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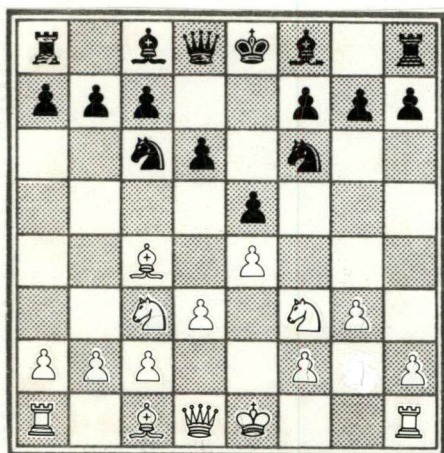
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mind over matter

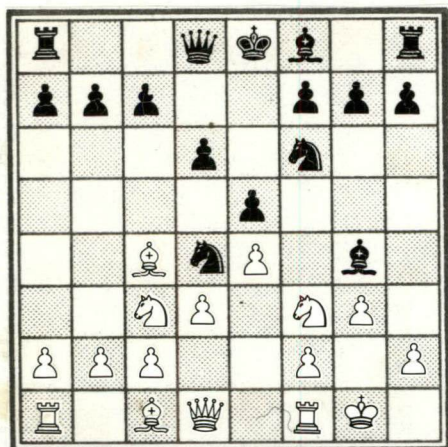
After the sparkling tactics of Jonathan Mestel, we descend to the rabbit warren for this incredible postal game, where black, a queen ahead, is completely wiped off the board. Have the hallowed principles of chess, which state that 'superior force wins, and vastly superior force wins even quicker', been overturned? Or are there some important lessons to be learnt from this never-say-die example of attacking chess?

1 P-K4	P-K4
2 N-KB3	P-Q3
3 N-QB3	N-KB3
4 P-KN3	N-QB3
5 B-B4	



A fairly normal beginning, though white's move P-KN3 followed by not fianchettoing the bishop looks quite strange. Still, worse is to follow.

5...	N-Q5
6 O-O	B-KN5
7 P-Q3???	



And now an inexplicable failure to defend the attacked knight at KB3 by 7 B-K2

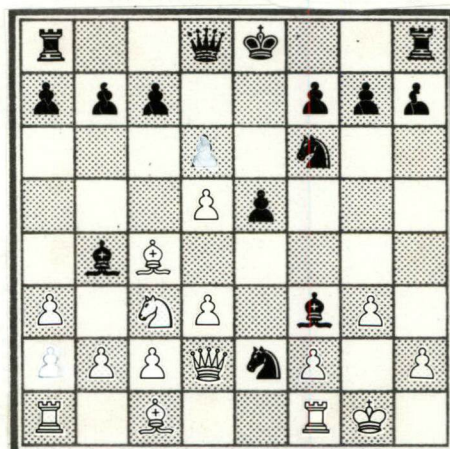
7... BxN

Black wins a piece

8 Q-Q2	P-Q4
9 PxP	B-QN5!

Black has a neat combination in mind with this move, which white fails to spot, otherwise he would have played 10 KR-K1 here, guarding the K2 square. The lapse is costly.

10 P-QR3?? N-K7ch!



A beautiful stroke. White now has to give up his queen, otherwise it's mate.

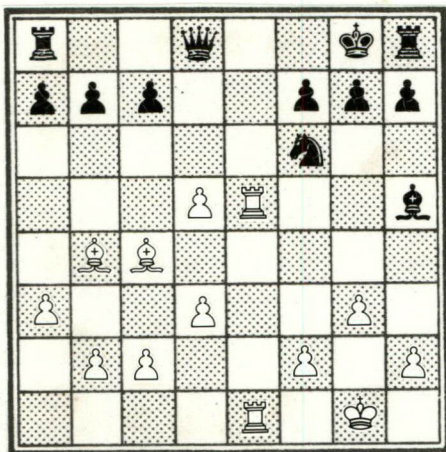
11 NxN	BxQ
12 BxB	

Still, only a queen, eh!

12	BxN
13 KR-K1	

Now white starts a counter attack

13	B-R4
14 RxPch	K-B1
15 B-N4 ch	K-N1
16 QR-K1	

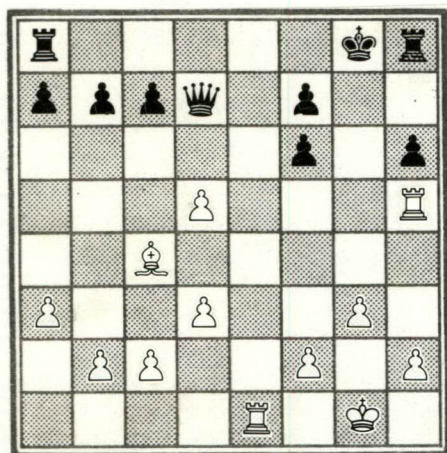


White has fully mobilised what is left of his army, but has no specific threat except the one black misses.

16 P-KR3?
17 B-K7!

This gains a piece back, because white now knocks out the knight at KB3 which was defending the bishop at KR4.

17 Q-Q2
18 BxN PxB
19 RxB



White has regained some ground in material, and also weakened the defences to the black king by doubling and isolating the black pawns. However, such gains can by no means offset the huge disadvantage of a queen loss, and by offering a rook exchange here by 19...R-K1, black could either liquidate the pieces, thus rendering the white attack impotent, or drive the white rook off its active open file.

As the game goes black does not make use of this trump card - the threat to exchange pieces - and also gravely underestimates what attacking chances white still possesses.

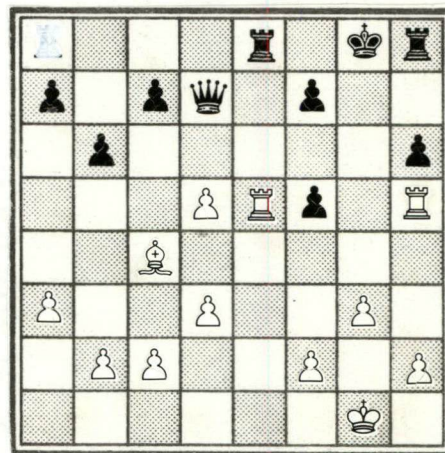
19... P-QN3?

Pointless in the extreme. I'd love to know what white's reason was for making this move. Maybe a reader can suggest a plausible thought sequence that might have made black choose it?!

20 R-K4!

White brings the second rook onto the attack.

20... P-KB4
21 R-K5 R-K1



Black offers the exchange, but now, however, white can sidestep it yet still maintain his rook in an active position. It would have been different had the rook still been on K.

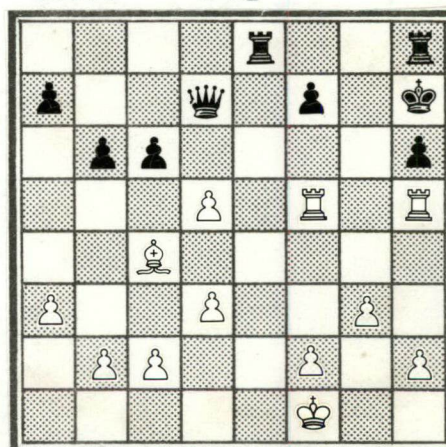
22 R(K5)xP P-QB3

Almost every black move from this point is a blunder. This one criminally opens the diagonal leading from the white bishop to KB7 square and thus increases white's attacking chances.

23 K-B1

White takes precautions against a possible mate at K1, which would be threatened after 24 PxP QxBP

23... K-R2

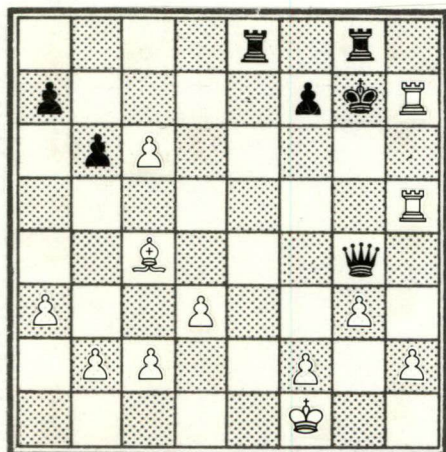


Any move to guard the KBP - 23... R-K2
or 23... R-R2 would have been better than
this.

24 R-B6!

The white rooks find a new target,
the KRP.

24... R(R1)-N1
25 R(B6)xRPch K-N2
26 PxP Q-N5
27 R-R7ch



White has now six pawns and a bishop
plus an attack for the queen and yet
he does not have the advantage, since
the six pawns are all passive objects
with no attacking or queening potential.
Black can afford to give up the exchange
after 27...K-B3 28 BxBP and still retain
winning chances.

The threats to the black king look
extremely dangerous, but in fact he is
a remarkably hard piece to mate unless,
unless...

27... K-B1??
28 RxP mate

... black walks into a mate in one.

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